Technical Writing and Evidence: Course Syllabus

This course develops the ability to produce technical documents that are clear, precise, and grounded in verifiable evidence. Over 12 weeks, students attend 24 sessions totaling 48 teaching hours, engaging with real-world writing tasks and evidence evaluation. The syllabus outlines learning outcomes, assessment methods, and weekly topics, with a focus on practical skills for professional contexts. All materials and activities are designed to foster critical thinking and ethical reporting.

Supporting records are presented in Figure 3.

Supporting records are presented in Table 1.

1 Course Overview and Learning Outcomes

Grade	Band	Descriptor	Outcome
A	Top	Exemplary	Mastery
B	High	Proficient	Competent
C	Middle	Developing	Satisfactory
D	Low	Emerging	Marginal
F	Below	Insufficient	Fail

Table 1: Grading scale and corresponding performance descriptors

The course provides a comprehensive introduction to technical writing principles and evidence-based practices. Students will learn to craft various technical documents, from reports to proposals, while integrating credible evidence. Emphasis is placed on clarity, audience analysis, and ethical standards. By the end, students should be able to plan, draft, and revise technical texts that meet professional requirements and withstand scrutiny.

1.1 Module Structure and Sequencing

The course is organized into sequential modules that build upon each other. Starting with foundational concepts, students progress to complex document types and evidence synthesis. Each module includes readings, exercises, and discussions that reinforce learning. The sequencing ensures that students develop skills incrementally, with ample opportunity to apply feedback and refine their work before advancing to more challenging assignments.

1.1.1 Core Module: Evidence Gathering and Evaluation

This module focuses on identifying, collecting, and assessing evidence from various sources. Students learn to distinguish between primary and secondary sources, evaluate credibility, and avoid bias. Practical activities include source audits and evidence

mapping. The module emphasizes the importance of transparency in citing evidence and the consequences of misrepresentation, preparing students for rigorous technical writing tasks.

Supporting records are presented in Table 2.

Criterion	Emerging	Proficient	Exemplary
Relevance	Limited	Adequate	Strong
Credibility	Unverified	Verified	Cross-checked
Synthesis	Lists	Connects	Integrates
Citation	Errors	Mostly correct	Flawless

Table 2: Evidence evaluation criteria and performance levels

1.1.1.1 Source Credibility and Bias Assessment

Students examine criteria for evaluating source credibility, including authority, accuracy, and currency. They practice assessing bias in both obvious and subtle forms, using checklists and peer review. Case studies illustrate how biased sources can distort technical conclusions. The goal is to equip students with systematic methods for vetting evidence before incorporation into their writing, ensuring that their documents reflect balanced and reliable information.

1.1.1.2 Data Collection and Documentation Standards

This section covers best practices for collecting and documenting data in technical contexts. Students learn to design simple data collection instruments, maintain meticulous records, and adhere to documentation standards that facilitate reproducibility. Emphasis is placed on ethical considerations, such as informed consent and data privacy, and on the importance of clear metadata to support evidence integrity throughout the writing process.

1.1.2 Applied Module: Technical Document Drafting

In this applied module, students draft a variety of technical documents, including memos, reports, and instructions. They apply evidence evaluation skills to select and integrate appropriate sources. Peer review and instructor feedback guide revisions. The module culminates in a portfolio of drafts that demonstrate growth in clarity, organization, and evidence use, preparing students for professional writing demands.

1.2 Module Assessment and Feedback

Assessment in the module structure is continuous and formative. Students receive feedback on exercises and drafts through peer review and instructor comments. Summative assessments include a midterm evidence evaluation project and a final document portfolio. Feedback is aligned with learning outcomes and emphasizes actionable improvements. The assessment strategy ensures that students can

demonstrate mastery of both writing and evidence skills by course end.

2 Assessment and Grading Policies

Assessment comprises several components designed to measure both theoretical understanding and practical application. Grades are based on participation, assignments, a midterm project, and a final portfolio. Clear rubrics are provided for each task, detailing expectations for evidence use, clarity, and accuracy. Late submissions are penalized unless prior arrangements are made. The policies aim to be fair, transparent, and supportive of student learning.

2.1 Assignment Types and Deadlines

Students complete a range of assignments, including weekly writing exercises, a source evaluation report, a technical instructions draft, and a final evidence-based report. Deadlines are spaced to allow for feedback and revision. The table below outlines key assignments and their due weeks. Each assignment builds toward the final portfolio, ensuring steady progress and opportunities to apply feedback.

Supporting records are presented in Figure 1.



Figure 1: Key assignments and due weeks

2.1.1 Grading Rubrics and Criteria

Rubrics for each assignment specify criteria such as evidence quality, organization, clarity, and adherence to conventions. Performance levels are described for each criterion, enabling students to self-assess and target improvements. Rubrics are discussed in class and available online. Consistency in grading is maintained through calibration among instructors and moderation of sample assignments, ensuring that all students are evaluated fairly.

2.1.1.1 Rubric for Evidence Integration

The evidence integration rubric assesses how well students select, evaluate, and incorporate evidence. Criteria include relevance, credibility, synthesis, and proper citation. Each criterion is rated on a scale from emerging to exemplary, with descriptors clarifying expectations. Students receive this rubric early and use it for self and peer review, fostering a clear understanding of standards for evidence-based writing.

2.1.1.2 Rubric for Clarity and Precision

This rubric focuses on language use, structure, and audience awareness. Criteria include conciseness, logical flow, correct terminology, and formatting. Descriptors guide students in producing documents that are easy to read and understand. The rubric is applied to all written assignments, and feedback highlights specific areas for improvement, helping students develop a professional writing style.

Supporting records are presented in Table 3.

Criterion	Emerging	Proficient	Exemplary
Conciseness	Wordy	Clear	Tight
Flow	Disjointed	Logical	Seamless
Terminology	Inconsistent	Consistent	Precise
Formatting	Poor	Adequate	Professional

Table 3: Clarity and precision rubric criteria

2.1.2 Peer Review and Self-Assessment Protocols

Peer review is integral to the course. Students follow structured protocols to provide constructive feedback on drafts, focusing on evidence use and clarity. Self-assessment checklists help students reflect on their own work before submission. These protocols cultivate critical evaluation skills and prepare students for collaborative writing environments, where giving and receiving feedback is routine.

2.2 Academic Integrity and Submission Guidelines

Academic integrity is paramount. All work must be original, and sources must be properly cited. Students are required to submit assignments through the designated platform, which checks for plagiarism. Guidelines for collaboration and use of generative tools are clearly stated. Violations result in disciplinary action as per institutional policy. The course emphasizes ethical writing practices and respect for intellectual property.

Supporting records are presented in Figure 2.



Figure 2: Checklist for academic integrity compliance



Figure 3: Course schedule overview